

Folio Space

Brand guidelines for the AI-powered
experience pod built for design candidates.

*Your work
speaks first.*

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What this *brand* actually stands for

We exist for the designer who has the work but not yet the opportunity — and our job is to close that gap with precision, not noise.

— CORE BRAND BELIEF

THE CATEGORY

Career intelligence platform for designers — not a job board, not a portfolio tool, not a recruiter database. All three, orchestrated.

THE SINGLE DIFFERENTIATOR

We evaluate portfolio-first. Skill before resume. Work before words.

TARGET AUDIENCE

Design students, fresh grads, freelancers, and junior professionals strong at craft and weak at the job-seeking system.

COMPETITOR GAP WE OWN

LinkedIn treats design work as an afterthought. Behance doesn't match. Internshala doesn't understand design. None give feedback. We do.

Why *Folio*

Folio refers to a portfolio leaf — a single page of work — and by extension, the body of work a designer carries. It's a word designers already own. It signals craft, not tech. The secondary suffix "Space" grounds it as a place — not just a document.

NAMING PRINCIPLE 1

Must mean something in design language. Not a made-up tech portmanteau. Not a verb with a dropped vowel.

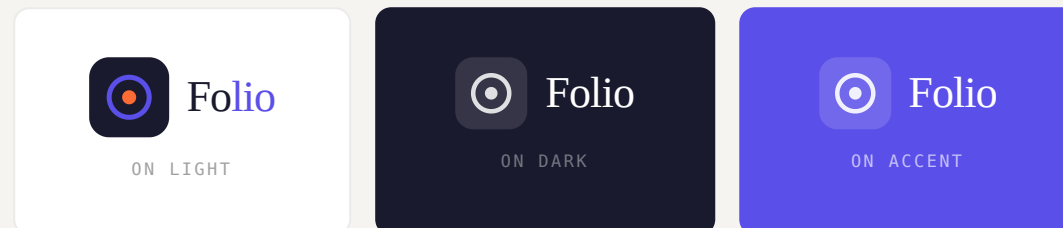
NAMING PRINCIPLE 2

Works as product noun and action. "Check your Folio."
"They found me on Folio." Both land.

ALTERNATIVES REJECTED

Canvas (taken by Canva), Craft (multi-tool conflict), Studio (too generic).

The *logo*



The mark is a **target / lens metaphor** — a circle with a centred dot. It references both a viewfinder (talent-spotting) and the iris of an eye (intelligence). The accent dot is Warm Orange, grounding it in human warmth against the electric-indigo ring.

DO

Always maintain minimum clear space equal to the height of the "F" in the wordmark around all four sides of the logo lock-up.

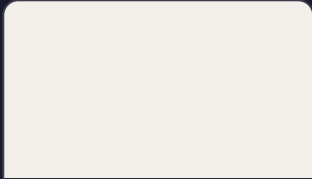
DON'T

Never recolour with off-palette colours. Never use wordmark alone under 120px. Never stretch or rotate the mark.

Six colours.

Each one earns its place.

Each colour is assigned a semantic role. They are not interchangeable. Mixing warm colour into AI features, or mint into negative states, breaks the system's logic.

 Midnight Navy #1A1A2E Primary. Headlines, backgrounds, logo. The authority base.	 Electric Indigo #5B4FE9 AI / intelligence signal. CTAs, active states, AI features.	 Warm Orange #FF6B35 Human warmth. Notifications, milestones, onboarding.	 Mint Confirmation #00C9A7 Success, progress, growth indicators. Positive feedback.	 Chalk #F2EFEA Page backgrounds, cards. Warmer than white — keeps the craft feel.	 Soft Lavender #A89FD6 Supporting accent. Subtle AI context. Never dominant.
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ELECTRIC INDIGO — USAGE RULE

Reserved for AI-powered features, primary CTAs, and interactive states. If something does intelligence, it gets indigo. Do not dilute this signal by applying it to decorative elements.

WARM ORANGE — USAGE RULE

Marks human moments only: receiving an interview, hitting a portfolio milestone, first match notification. The warm colour is earned, not ambient. Overuse breaks its meaning.

MINT CONFIRMATION — USAGE RULE

Success states, "do" examples, positive feedback indicators, career progress bars. Only used when a genuine positive outcome has occurred. Not for encouragement or upsell.

Type is the
personality

DISPLAY — DM SERIF DISPLAY

Your work
is the proof.

56PX · -0.02EM · HEADLINES, HERO TEXT, BRAND STATEMENTS

BODY — DM SANS

The platform surfaces opportunities that match your actual ability — not your job title. Upload once. Let the intelligence work. Design students, this was built for you.

17PX · WEIGHT 300–500 · UI LABELS, DESCRIPTIONS, BODY COPY

UTILITY — SPACE MONO

MATCH SCORE · 94% · PORTFOLIO INTELLIGENCE
· AI EVALUATION

10–13PX · 0.12–0.18EM TRACKING · UPPERCASE · LABELS, METADATA, SYSTEM TAGS

DISPLAY	Aa	52px / -0.02em
H1	Aa	36px / -0.01em
H2	Section Heading	24px / DM Sans 500
BODY	Regular paragraph text flows here with good measure.	17px / 300–400
LABEL	METADATA · TAGS · SYSTEM	11px / Space Mono

The logic of this pairing: DM Serif Display carries warmth and editorial credibility — it signals a thoughtful product, not another startup app. DM Sans brings clarity and readability at small sizes. Space Mono isolates system information visually — scores, metadata, labels — making it instantly distinguishable from editorial content.

PAIRING RATIONALE		
DM Serif	DM Sans	Space Mono
Editorial warmth. Signals craft. Differentiates from SaaS defaults.	Legible at 12px. Contemporary. Neutral enough to disappear.	Creates visual contrast for data. Isolates system metadata from prose.

How this brand *speaks*

The brand speaks like a **senior designer who actually mentors** — not like a startup that's excited about AI. It tells candidates the truth about where they stand, gives specific direction, and doesn't celebrate mediocrity.

Honest

Precise

Encouraging

Progressive

Grounded

Direct

Craft-first

Intelligent

Non-patronising

What we say

- Plain, specific feedback: "Your case study lacks a problem statement. Add context before showing solutions."
- Earned encouragement: "You've applied to 6 roles this month. Here's what's working."
- Active, present tense: "3 companies are reviewing your portfolio right now."
- Treats users as professionals: Uses domain-specific language. Doesn't over-explain design concepts.

What we never say

- Generic hype: "Unlock your full potential!" / "Your dream job awaits!"
- AI-speak: "Our cutting-edge AI algorithms leverage machine learning to..."
- Infantilising warmth: "Great job submitting your portfolio! 🎉 You're amazing!"
- Passive hedging: "It seems like you might want to consider perhaps updating your..."

Voice *applied*

ONBOARDING WELCOME

FOLIO VOICE

Your portfolio is the only credential that matters here. Let's set it up properly.

NOT THIS

~~Welcome! We're so excited to have you on board. Let's get started on your amazing journey!~~

APPLICATION STATUS

FOLIO VOICE

Shortlisted. Arya Studio has reviewed your portfolio and wants to move forward. Interview window: 12–16 June.

NOT THIS

~~Congratulations! 🎉 You've been shortlisted! Your hard work is paying off. Keep it up!~~

PORTFOLIO FEEDBACK (AI)

FOLIO VOICE

2 of your 4 case studies don't show your design process. Recruiters for UX roles look for wireframes and iteration. Add process documentation to improve your match score.

NOT THIS

~~Your portfolio is great! Maybe you could try to potentially add a little more process work if you feel like it might help!~~

When and *how* things move

MICRO

150ms

Button press,
hover, icon
transitions.

UI

TRANSITION

240ms

Panel
open/close,
modal, tab
switching.

PAGE /

SCREEN

360ms

Route
transitions,
dashboard
load.

Use **ease-out** for elements entering the screen. Use **ease-in-out** for state transitions. Never use **linear** easing — it reads as unpolished. No bounce, spring, or elastic for UI. Motion is a precise tool, not a toy.

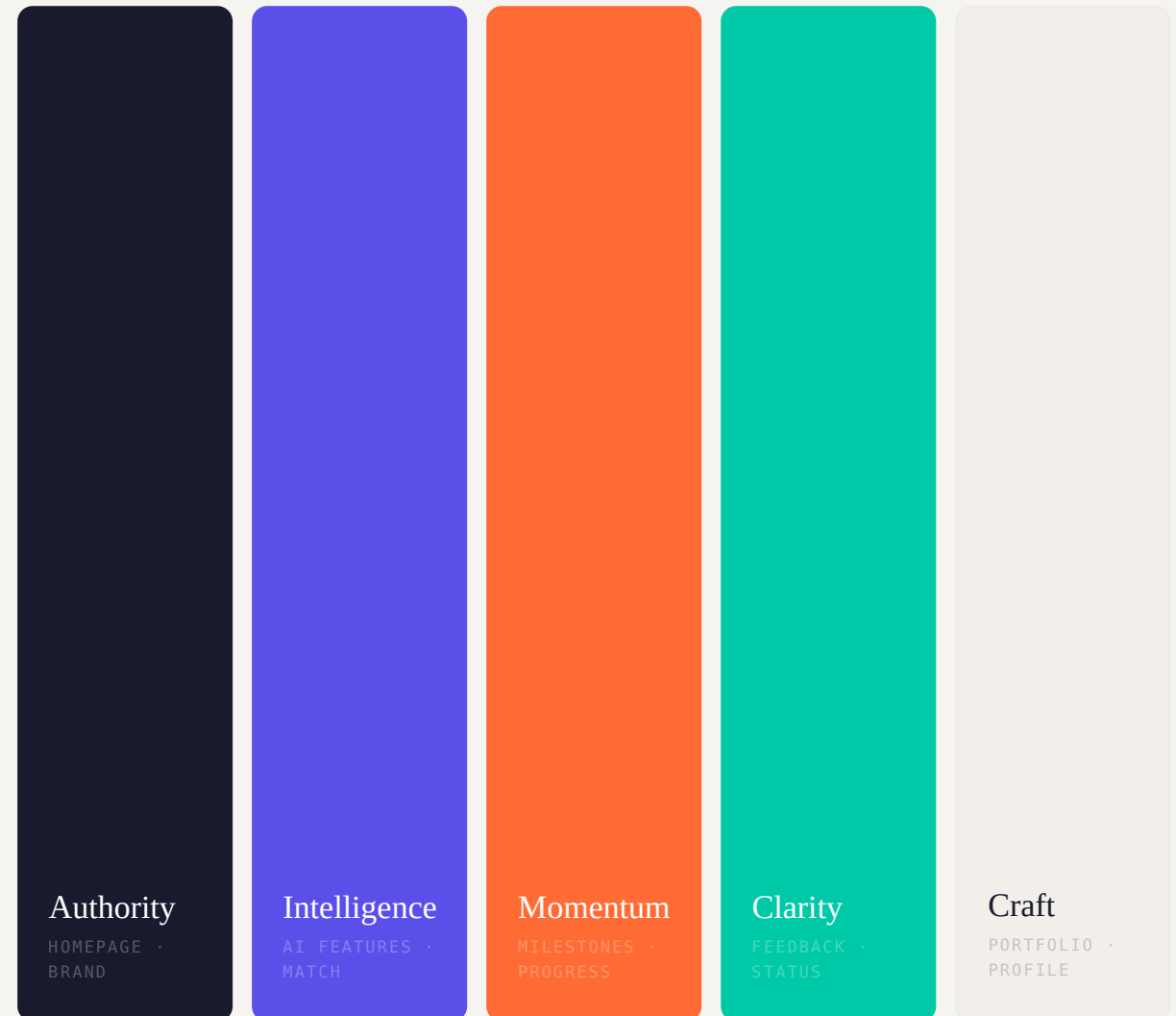
ICONOGRAPHY

All icons: **outline-only, 1.5px stroke, 24px grid.**

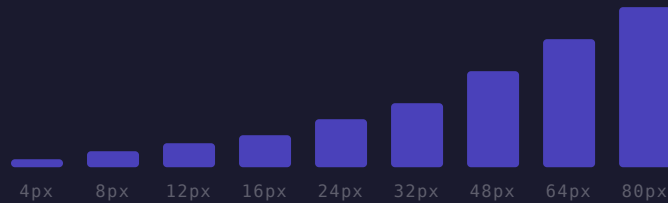
Recommended sets: Phosphor or Lucide. Do not mix filled and outline icons at the same hierarchy level.

The *emotional* register

The platform doesn't have a single mood — it has contextual register. Five emotional modes the brand shifts between across different touchpoints.



The *grid*



Base unit: **4px**. All spacing is a multiple of 4. This is not a loose guideline — it's a hard system. Max content width: **1200px** desktop. Cards follow a 12-column grid with **24px gutters**.

The words we *own*

"Your work speaks first."

Direct. Platform-defining. Tells you exactly what's different without mentioning AI or technology. The work is the credential.

- "Intelligence behind every match."
- "Not a job board. A career engine."
- "Designed for designers."
- "From portfolio to placement."

Words we own: Portfolio-first · Match score · Career intelligence · Creative talent · Work speaks · Design discipline · Placement

Words we avoid: "Dream job" · "Supercharge" · "Revolutionary" · "Cutting-edge" · "Gamechanger" · "Seamless" · "Leverage" · "Synergy" · anything that sounds like a press release or a Series A pitch deck